"I'm damaged goods."

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Where it often comes from

After divorce, abuse, a sexual past, repeated rejection, or being used, many people feel permanently marked. The phrase "damaged goods" may have been said to us, or we may say it ourselves. It treats us like an object that has lost value, and it can shape what we think we deserve in a relationship.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture speaks of healing wounds and not discarding people. "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." The LORD says, "I will restore your health and heal your wounds… because they call you an outcast, Zion, for whom no one cares." Isaiah 61:1 says He came "to bind up the brokenhearted." "If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." And "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you." People are not goods, and God does not mark down the wounded. The hurt is real, and it is not your identity.

> *"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds"* (Psalm 147:3).

Also see

> "But I will restore your health and heal your wounds, declares the LORD, because they call you an outcast, Zion, for whom no one cares" (Jeremiah 30:17).

> "The Spirit of the Lord GOD is on Me, because the LORD has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and freedom to the prisoners" (Isaiah 61:1).

> "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life" (Isaiah 43:4).

Common self-statements

- No one wants someone with my history.
- I am used and worthless.
- I am permanently broken.
- I have less to offer than other people.
- My past has ruined me.
- I do not deserve a good relationship.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Calling myself "damaged goods."
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I am defective.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either whole or ruined.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will love me.

Challenging questions

- Where did the phrase “damaged goods” come from, and who first said it?
- Is a person with a painful history a thing that has lost value?
- What strengths have I developed because of what I survived?
- What does God say about the wounded?
- What would I say to a friend who called herself or himself this?
- What kind of healing would help me most?

Truth summary

> I am not goods, and I am not ruined. I have been wounded, and God heals the brokenhearted. In Christ I am a new creation, precious and honored. I deserve respect and can pursue healing.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Guilt/Shame
- Hardship
- Child Abuse/Neglect
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

Clean — Natalie Grant
God’s cleansing grace challenges the belief that shame or sin makes a person beyond restoration.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm damaged goods"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm damaged goods." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did this label come from?
- ☐ What have I survived?
- ☐ What strengths do I have?
- ☐ What does God say?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What healing do I need?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.
- ☐ He binds up my wounds.
- ☐ I am a new creation.
- ☐ I am precious and honored.
- ☐ My history is not my identity.
- ☐ I deserve respect.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ Jeremiah 30:17
  "But I will restore your health and heal your wounds, declares the LORD, because they call you an outcast, Zion, for whom no one cares."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Healing and worth: Each day, write one sign of healing and one truth about your worth.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 147:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up my wounds.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the source. Write who called you damaged and what you believe now.
- [ ] Replace the label. Write truthful words about yourself.
- [ ] Seek healing. Consider counseling, especially for abuse or trauma.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 61:1–3. Pray it over your story.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm damaged goods": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Healing and worth
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm damaged goods.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You heal the brokenhearted and bind up wounds. Remove the label I have worn. Heal me, restore my worth, and help me see myself as You do. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.